Survival instincts

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Survival instincts

by Dagemagar

Summary

Paris fears Hawkmoth.
Everyone knows the destruction and chaos he has created. The city knows not to mistake him for anything less than a monster.
So when an accidental encounter leaves Nathalie Sancouer trapped in his arms after threatening him, she hopes that will be the first and last meeting with the supervillain.

Hawkmoth is pretty insistent that it isn't.

Writing this fic because hawknath's potential was mwah chef's kiss. But once again miraculous robbed us.

Notes

See the end of the work for notes

The alleyway was a shortcut.

One Nathalie Sancouer had used many times before on days like this, when meeting stretched out because business partners love the sound of their own voice or other types of frustrating people that took up way to much of her time. It had been another one of those days except this time an intern had been ripped to shreds by Gabriel Agreste for making a typo on her presentation.

She had chosen to pass through a narrow passage between an old apartment building and a breakfast place.

She had come out of work after talking to an incredibly persistent journalist who seemed set on getting a specific answer and got aggressive when he didn't, only to see crowds of people, staring up at the night sky holding their phones and whispering to each other.

That was always a bad sign.

She had checked her phone for a news report and just as she had expected, Hawkmoth was attacking.

She had chosen to pass through this alleyway, so she could get home safer.

People had agreed ever since Hawkmoth's first attack that there was safety in numbers, but Nathalie had already understood that it was pointless. If he wanted to hurt someone, he was going to do it.

That's why Nathalie was alone, at night while a psychopath was on the loose with crashes sounding like they were getting eerily closer, but she told herself that it must be a trick of her mind. That exhaustion was getting to her.

"Come on, Cat noir! He's getting away!"

Nathalie recognized the voice of the young hero in spots, most likely hunting down Hawkmoth's akumatized villain.

She looked to her left, ready to step out to the side while she tried to find out where the villain was, just to make sure she was safe when someone slammed into her shoulder with a speed that seemed supernatural.

Whoever had bumped into her seemed to stumble, unaware of what had stopped them.

Nathalie turned around, ready to tell them to watch out, expecting someone rushing to get away from the danger.

Instead, she saw the danger itself.

Hawkmoth was standing less than two feet away from her, his face distorted from anger.

Nathalie's breath caught, as his fists tightened like he wanted to hit her and was barely stopping himself. He opened his mouth to speak, but she interrupted him.

"They're after you."

"Great survival instincts, Nathalie" The woman thought to herself.

He put a finger up to his lips to silence her and was about to run again, but his action planted an idea in Nathalie's head. "I'll tell them which way you're going." He froze in place. "They're close by, you can't stay or they'll catch you."

Nathalie knew she was bluffing. She had no idea how far away they were, but she couldn't to wrong by the way Hawkmoth's eyes narrowed at her words. She raised an eyebrow in return.

She continued "You can't run much longer, can you? You're tired."

As much as she was pretending to be in control, she was also buying time for the heroes to find them.

Nathalie was about to continue when he moved.

One moment she was borderline threatening the most wanted man in France and the next she was slammed against him, getting dragged out to the side with her back against his chest.

One of his hands was locked around her waist, the other was crushed over her mouth.

She could see that he had pulled her into a partition, ironically enough the exact place where she had wanted to check up on the akuma attack.

It had happened so quickly she barely registered the movement before she was trapped.

Hawkmoth leaned down and whispered "Quiet." Right into her ear reminding her just how close he was. The word sounded like a command.

Not one she was going to follow.

She drove her elbow backwards into his ribs.

Hawkmoth grunted but his grip didn't loosen.

She tried again. His arm adjusted and he muttered "Enough."

She bit his palm as hard as she could and this time it earned a reaction.

His fingers tightened around her jaw, and he pulled her head a bit further into his chest.

The pressure was not enough to hurt, but enough to remind her that he absolutely could.

For the first time, genuine fear crawled down her spine.

Hawkmoth didn't even need to threaten violence, but the possibility was there every moment she was stuck in his grip.

There were steps and voices a few feet away from them now.

"M'lady I swear I saw him run this way."

"Maybe he tricked us?"

"Lets just look." Cat noir said.

The steps got closer and Nathalie considered fighting him again. There was a chance the heroes could hear it this time, but Hawkmoth's grip tightened like he was reminding her just how screwed she would be if she tried and failed.

She hated this.

Hated the feeling of not having any control.

She didn't have much time to consider as the steps got farther away again and finally Ladybug said "I think it's a dead-end kitty. Let's see if he continued running that way."

Chat Noir agreed and they were gone as quickly as they got here.

Hawkmoth on the other hand was still breathing down her neck, though he seemed in no rush to let her go, as he kept his grip on Nathalie unyielding.

It wasn't until what she guessed was a few minutes later that he whispered, "I'm going to let you go now, but if you scream, then I'll grab you and won't let go again for a good while yet."

He luckily took her lack of protest as a yes, not that she really could do a lot and let the hand on her mouth drop to his side.

Nathalie turned her head slightly to get a better look at him and said, "Let go of me."

"I'll let you go completely if you don't try hitting me again *and* you don't say a word about this to *anyone*."

Lots of demands" She thought, rolling her eyes.

"Fine." She said evenly.

He hesitantly let go of her and she stepped away from him, the second she got the chance.

Nathalie turned and looked him dead in the eye, the supervillain of Paris.

End Notes

Damn this chapter is long tho??

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